



Delaware County Council Meeting June 22nd 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5odeWOEn2kg
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: June 22, 2021

Location: Commissioners' Courtroom, Delaware County, Indiana

Presiding Officer: President Alexander

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Alexander called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order at 9:00 AM. Opening statements noted that public questions may be directed to county council via co.delaware.in, and while streaming was temporarily affected by an internet connection issue, the meeting was recorded to be posted later.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes.
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Alexander.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Jane.
 - **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved following a motion by Ms. Piper and a second by Mr. Ballard, passed by roll call vote unanimously.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The May meeting minutes were approved following a motion by Ms. Lasseter and a second by Ms. Piper, passed by roll call vote unanimously.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:18 Ordinance 2021-016: Ordinance Authorizing Delaware County, Indiana to Issue its Taxable Economic Development Revenue Bonds (Can Pack)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brad Bookout introduced the first reading of the ordinance regarding the Can Pack economic development revenue bonds. He noted prior unanimous approvals from the county commissioners, economic development commission, and planning commission, with a county redevelopment commission hearing scheduled for the upcoming Thursday.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to introduce by Mr. Quakenbush, second by Ms. Piper. Passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **00:05:03 Ordinance 2021-015: Second Reading & Amendment for Taxable Economic Development Revenue Bonds (Living Greens Farm / LGF Properties - Muncie, LLC)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookout and Rachel Gardner (CBRE).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brad Bookout presented the second reading and requested an amendment to correct the company name in the first paragraph of the ordinance to "LGF Properties-Muncie, LLC". Rachel Gardner shared project updates, noting that Living Greens Farm is conducting due diligence on building, expects to start construction in October, aims to be operational by late 2022/early 2023, and fully ramped up by the end of 2024.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to amend name by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Ballard; approved by roll call vote.
 - Motion to approve Ordinance 2021-015 by Ms. Piper, second by Ms. Lasseter; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **00:08:25 Financial Transfers, Addendums, and Budget Adjustments**
 - **Commissioners (Fund 173):** Minus \$60,324 (Health Insurance) / Plus \$60,324 (Telephones). Total request: \$0. Motion to approve by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Webb; passed unanimously by roll call vote.

- **Assessor (A106):** Minus \$2,000 (Personal Property Associate) / Plus \$2,000 (Part-time). Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Quakenbush; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Circuit Court (C146/D146, C147/D147, B165/C165, A168/B168):** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator) explained staff shuffling at juvenile court and juvenile probation, converting a juvenile probation secretary into a court secretary to improve departmental efficiency without requesting new employee lines. Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Ms. Lasseter; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Coroner (198/311):** Minus \$5,000 (Autopsy) / Plus \$5,000 (Part-time). Reduced at the finance committee's recommendation, offset by expected prisoner autopsy reimbursements from Newcastle Correctional Facility. Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Lasseter, second by Ms. Piper; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **EMS (117):** Refilling a position. Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Quakenbush; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Family Support (102):** Shuffling of staff due to a deputy prosecutor position replacement. Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Ballard; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Jail (135/106):** Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Webb; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Prosecutor (103):** Corrected account line transfer (A103). Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Quakenbush; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Lit Prosecutor (119):** Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Webb; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Auditor Addendum Transfer (118/110):** Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Ballard; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Public Defender (153):** Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Quakenbush; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Treasurer (C103/B106/A107):** Internal staff transfers. Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Ms. Lasseter; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Jail Overtime & Inmate Meals (JL C108, D138, B102, B141, D111, Uniforms, School, Overtime, Inmate Meals 224):**
 - *Deliberation Summary:* The Sheriff and staff explained severe staffing shortages, a revolving door of hires (including one who lasted a single day), and burnout forcing high overtime usage. The jail's annual overtime budget was exhausted by May. Funds are being temporarily borrowed from the inmate meals budget (\$30,000) with plans to request a formal General Fund/Cares Act appropriation next month of approximately \$130,000 to cover the remainder of the year.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to approve by Mr. Quakenbush, second by Ms. Piper; passed unanimously by roll call vote.

- **Jail Lowit (105/108):** Total request: \$0. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Ballard; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Commissioners ARP Transfer:** Withdrawn by the administration, with expectations to bring it back next month out of the general fund.
- **Emergency Management / GIS (19 - GIS):** \$15,000 request (\$2,900 supplies, \$3,600 contractual, \$8,500 equipment) funded by a final grant from the Ball Brothers Foundation to support ongoing COVID response and emergency preparedness. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Ms. Lasseter; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Sales Disclosure (212 - Form 11):** \$4,158 request for supplies. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Webb; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Adult User Fees (197):** \$5,000 for part-time to cover lost probation secretary hours. Motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Quakenbush; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Family Recovery Court Grant (101):** Emily Anderson explained restructuring a half-grant/half-county position into a full-time grant-funded Family Recovery Court Coordinator position (\$45,400 annual salary). Total request: \$25,008. Motion by Mr. Webb, second by Ms. Piper; passed unanimously by roll call vote.
- **Overall Omnibus Financial Action:** Motion to approve financial transfers, amend salary ordinance with reductions, and amend hiring freeze ordinance passed via motion by Ms. Piper, second by Mr. Ballard, and unanimous roll call vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:58:31 Rick Yancer** (Address: 500 West)
 - **Concerns:** Expressed concern that local government is misinterpreting federal stimulus money guidelines, noting that funds were intended for public health and assisting struggling residents facing rent, utility, hunger, and homelessness issues rather than funding large institutions or corporations. Also criticized previous tax and utility increases during the pandemic.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Molly Hunt (Delaware County Purdue Extension) introduced Shaylee Ledbetter as the new assistant health and human services educator.
 - Provided an update on the Delaware County 4-H Fair running July 7th through July 18th, noting safety plans encouraging social distancing without mask mandates, and highlighted the Second Harvest Food Bank "Fairs Cares" food drive.

- Acknowledged the recent passing of Kirk and Deb Mason, offering condolences to their families.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment was approved following a motion by Ms. Piper and a second by Mr. Ballard, passed unanimously by roll call vote.
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